Congress of the United States

Washington, DC 20515

November 21, 2025

Federal Energy Regulatory Commission
Commissioners
888 First Street NE
Washington, DC 20426

Dear Commissioners,

We write regarding the Department of Energy's (DOE) recent letter to the Federal Energy Regulatory Commission (FERC) which requested an initiation of a rulemaking process on the interconnection of large loads. The rapid growth of data centers, driven by artificial intelligence and cloud computing applications, presents both an economic opportunity and new challenges to the affordability and reliability of our electric grid.

The impacts of the expansion of both the data industry and the transmission infrastructure required to power it are disproportionately affecting residents surrounding the industry. Rate payers in markets with data centers have been subject to higher utility bills as the costs of transmission upgrades and expansions are distributed based on current allocation practices. Additionally, there have been “near miss” incidents in regions with rigorous data center buildout which have raised concerns about black outs when clusters of data centers have suddenly dropped off the grid.

We recognize the need for an efficient, standardized, and transparent interconnection process, and we urge FERC to ensure the forthcoming rulemaking process fully considers:

1. Safeguards to prevent large load customers from shifting interconnection or transmission upgrade costs onto existing rate payers.
2. Clear communication between FERC, state regulators, utilities, and local communities before approving large interconnections that may alter demand forecasts or infrastructure needs.
3. Authorizing utility-administered curtailment protocols during grid emergencies.
4. Cumulative impacts of multiple large facilities locating within a single region, including effects on transmission congestion, local generation adequacy, and resource adequacy planning.

5. Robust opportunities for community input.

We respectfully request that FERC include congressional stakeholders and state public utility commissions in this process to guarantee that affordability, reliability, and fairness remain a top priority of federal energy policy. I look forward to continued engagement with FERC as this process advances.

Sincerely,

Suhas Subramanyam
Member of Congress

John W. Mannion
Member of Congress

Mike Quigley
Member of Congress

Donald S. Beyer Jr.
Member of Congress